

Swarmfront Beta Critical Path

This is the shortest honest version of what has to be true before beta. The goal is not polish for its own sake. The goal is to avoid a bad first impression and make the unveil feel real, smooth, and premium enough to land.

Bottom line	The real launch risk is not map count or sound polish. It is multiplayer reliability and a clean first-match experience. Everything else matters less.
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Priority order

1	Multiplayer handshake and match flow Test this first and hardest. If multiplayer fails once in front of beta users, the game feels dead no matter how good everything else is.
2	First-match experience Players need to get into a game fast, understand what is happening, and feel that the game is responsive and fair.
3	Hive system It does not need to be final or fully complete, but it needs to feel good. The hive system is the face of the game.
4	Map pool Do not chase fifty maps just to say you have fifty maps. A smaller pool of strong maps is better than a large pool with weak ones.
5	Sound pass Helpful, but not critical. A minimal pass is enough for beta if time gets tight.

Minimum beta checklist

Must be done	Two phones complete a live match cleanly.
Must be done	Test Wi-Fi and cellular combinations.
Must be done	Test backgrounding, lock screen, and app return behavior.
Must be done	Run a 3-player game. Run a 4-player game if possible.

Should be done	Hive system feels responsive, readable, and intentional.
Should be done	At least 10–15 strong maps are tested and ready.
Can slip	Basic menu/gameplay sound layer is integrated.

One more thing to protect

Before beta, make sure there is at least one undeniable “that’s sick” moment in the game. It does not need to be ten moments. It needs to be one. That moment is what people remember and repeat.

Examples: a clean hive activation, a sharp swarm collision moment, an instant rematch flow, or a comeback that feels obvious and earned.